Eggs

Linguistic examples with minimalist syntax

Version 0.7.0

April 2026

https://github.com/retroflexivity/typst-eggs

Eggs is a Typst package for typesetting linguistic examples. Its aim is to provide a Typst analogue to LaTeX `gb4e`, `expex`, `linguex`, etc. Additionally, it ships with `leipzig`-style gloss abbreviations.

This is a documentation on Eggs. It begins with a review of features, then provides an extensive list of functions and their arguments.

1. Initializing

To use Eggs, first import it, and then set its config via a global show rule.[1]

```
#import "@preview/eggs:0.7.0"
#show: eggs
```

This same function is used to configure Eggs' settings. See below.

2. Examples

The primary fuction of Eggs is `example`. It acceps any `content` and typesets it as a single top-level linguistic example.

```
The sentence below demonstrates the reading known as specificational.
#example[
  The primary function of Eggs is `example`.
]
The semantics of the DP to the left of _is_ has been an object of much debate.
```

The sentence below demonstrates the reading known as specificational.

(1) The primary function of Eggs is `example`.

The semantics of the DP to the left of *is* has been an object of much debate.

Examples are automatically numbered continuously. To override automatic numbering, pass the `number` argument. Examples with a custom number do not increment the counter, so numbering continues where it was left off.

```
The idea of Predicate Inversion stems from the seeming parallelism of the following
sentences.
#example[
  `example` is the primary function of Eggs.
]
#example(number: 1)[
  The primary function of Eggs is `example`.
]
```

The idea of Predicate Inversion stems from the seeming parallelism of the following sentences.

(2) `example` is the primary function of Eggs.

(1) The primary function of Eggs is `example`.

[1] This package follows Typst's tradition of not abbreviating function names too much. Naturally, to achieve more effortless (or TeX-like) experience, you can set some aliases on import, e.g.

```
#import "@preview/eggs:0.7.0": example as ex, subexample as subex, judge as j, ex-label as el, ex-ref as er
```

The counter can also be set to an absolute value with `#counter("eggsample").update(n)` or a relative one with `#counter("eggsample").update(it => it + n)`. Following examples will be numbered starting with the next number. See counter for more info.

By default, examples in each footnote are numbered separately. They also use their own formatting. The following footnote[2] demonstrates this.

3. Subexamples

Numbered lists inside examples (lines that begin with `+ `) are automatically typeset as subexamples.

```
Compare the following two sentences, of which only the former exhibits the Definiteness
Effect.
#example[
  + There is a/\*the subexample.
  + Here is a/the subexample.
]
```

Compare the following two sentences, of which only the former exhibits the Definiteness Effect.

(3) a. There is a/*the subexample.
b. Here is a/the subexample.

In case you prefer it manual, the function `subexample` is defined. It is intended to only be used inside `example`. Automatic conversion of numbered lists can be toggled off by setting `auto-subexamples: false` in the config (see Section 8). To suspend it for a single example, pass `auto-subexamples: false` to the example directly.

```
Compare the following two sentences, of which only the former exhibits the Definiteness
Effect.
#example(auto-subexamples: false)[
  #subexample[There is a/\*the subexample.]
  #subexample[Here is a/the subexample.]
]
```

Compare the following two sentences, of which only the former exhibits the Definiteness Effect.

(3) a. There is a/*the subexample.
b. Here is a/the subexample.

[2] Examples in footnotes use a separate counter, `fn-eggsample`, which is set to 0 at the beginning of each footnote.

```
But note the contrast in availability of indefinites.

#example[
  `example` is the/a function of Eggs.
]
#example[
  The/??a function of Eggs is `example`.
]
```

But note the contrast in availability of indefinites.

(i) `example` is the/a function of Eggs.

(ii) The/??a function of Eggs is `example`.

3.1. Customizing how subexamples are displayed

By default, automatic subexamples are simply placed one after another. This can be changed by passing or setting `subexample-wrapper`. A wrapper is a function that accepts any number of `content` elements and returns `content` constructed from them.

A simple and common use case is to align subexamples horizontally using a grid.

```
Unfortunately, according to the conference guidelines, in this abstract, our space is
limited to two pages. Consequently, to be able to fit everything included in our agenda, we
will try to save as much space as possible by aligning subexamples horizontally instead of,
how it is usually done in linguistic papers, vertically.

#show: eggs.with(subexample-wrapper: grid.with(columns: 5))

#example[
  + This is also a subexample.
  + This, too, is a subexample.
  + This is a subexample, too.
]
```

Unfortunately, according to the conference guidelines, in this abstract, our space is limited to two pages. Consequently, to be able to fit everything included in our agenda, we will try to save as much space as possible by aligning subexamples horizontally instead of, how it is usually done in linguistic papers, vertically.

(4) a. This is also a subexample. b. This, too, is a subexample. c. This is a subexample, too.

4. Glosses

Bullet lists in examples (lines that begin with `- `) are automatically treated as gloss lines.

For words to split, you need to ensure that there is a `space` element between them. The easiest way to do it is to separate words with **more than one** space. There are exceptions, so use ~ (non-breaking space) for spaces you don't want to be treated as separators.

Translations and preambles are written as lines below and above glosses, respectively.

```
The following example presents the Russian _eto_-construction.
#example[
  Russian
  - Jajca      eto   vkusno.
  - eggs  this            tasty
  'Eggs are tasty.'
]
```

The following example presents the Russian *eto*-construction.

(5) Russian
Jajca eto vkusno.
eggs this tasty
'Eggs are tasty.'

Glosses can by typeset manually with `gloss`. It accepts either a content, which it splits automatically, or a list. Automatic bullet list conversion can be toggled off by setting `auto-glosses:`

`false` in the config (see Section 8). To suspend it for a single example, pass `auto-glosses: false` to the (sub)example directly.

```
The following example presents the Russian _eto_-construction.
#example(auto-glosses: false)[
  Russian
  #gloss(
    [Jajca      eto   vkusno.],
    ([eggs], [this], [tasty]),
  )
  'Eggs are tasty.'
]
```

The following example presents the Russian *eto*-construction.

(5) Russian
Jajca eto vkusno.
eggs this tasty
'Eggs are tasty.'

5. Judges

Certain strings at the beginning of a line or a gloss word (see Section 4) are automatically transformed into left judges.[3] Left judges are negatively padded strings that take up no space.

By default, such strings are `*`, `#`, `?`, `OK`, and all combinations of these. All except the asterisk are also superscripted. Spaces after a judge are omitted for readability.

```
The following pair shows the information-structural rigidity of specificational sentences.
#example[
  + OK SMITH is the killer.
  +  \*THE KILLER is Smith.
]
```

The following pair shows the information-structural rigidity of specificational sentences.

(6) a. OK SMITH is the killer.
b. *THE KILLER is Smith.

This can be modified by tweaking `auto-judges` in the config (see Section 8) or by passing the `auto-judges` argument to an example directly. `auto-judges` takes a dictionary where keys are the strings to treat as judges and values indicate whether to additionally superscript them. For instance, if you would like to make hashes and question marks non-superscripted, try `auto-judges: ("\*": false, "\#": false, "?": false, "OK": true)`. Use `auto-judges: ()` to disable the automatic conversion completely.

Again, a function `judge` is provided to typeset judges manually. Following spaces are **not** omitted.

[3] In fact, due to the way show rules work, this happens at the beginning of any elements inside examples, including inline ones. This might overgenerate left judges in certain narrow cases like in `this one _?here_`. Disable auto judges if it is a problem.

```
The following pair shows the information-structural rigidity of specificational sentences.
#example(auto-judges: ())[
  + #judge(super[OK])SMITH is the killer.
  + #judge[\*]THE KILLER is Smith.
]
```

The following pair shows the information-structural rigidity of specificational sentences.

(5) a. ^{OK}SMITH is the killer.
b. *THE KILLER is Smith.

N.B. Avoid using `judge` with strings that are already in `auto-judges`, as this can lead to superscript doubling.

6. Abbreviations

Eggs provides the whole set of Leipzig Standard Abbreviations as commands, in the style of TeX's `leipzig`. They are imported from a subpackage `abbreviations`.

All abbreviations are in lowercase. All abbreviations' names are as they appear, except for:

- **1, 2, 3** are `p1`, `p2`, `p3`
- **N** (as the non- prefix) is `non`

```
#import abbreviations: ins, pst, n

Note that the famous temperature examples forbid Instrumental in Russian.
#example[
  - \*Temperatur-oj  byl-o        10~gradusov.
  - weather-#ins             be-#pst\-#n  10~degrees
]
```

Note that the famous temperature examples forbid Instrumental in Russian.

(6) *Temperatur-oj byl-o 10 gradusov.
weather-INS be-PST-N 10 degrees

Custom abbreviations can be created by defining a new `abbreviation`.

```
#let eto = abbreviation("eto", "an extremely polysemous expression")

Due to the polysemy _eto_ exhibits, I will gloss it simply as #eto.
#example[
  - Eto   čto   za   primer?
  - #eto  what  for  example
  'What's this example?'
]
```

Due to the polysemy *eto* exhibits, I will gloss it simply as ETO.

(7) Eto čto za primer?
ETO what for example
'What's this example?'

The list of currently used abbreviations is stored as a dictionary of the form `abbr: description` inside the `used-abbreviations` state. The final list of abbreviations can be accessed as `#context state("used-abbreviations").final()`. There is also a function to print it as a term list.

```
The list of glossing abbreviations used in this paper:
#print-abbreviations()
```

The list of glossing abbreviations used in this paper:

INS instrumental
PST past
N neuter
ETO an extremely polysemous expression

N.B. It's better if you not import all abbreviations into the global namespace, as in `#import abbreviations: *`. There are much more of them then in the standard Leipzig, and some (like `top`) override Typst built-ins, which may lead to unexpected behavior. If you need a lot of abbreviations, use qualified import: do `#import abbreviations as ab`, then refer to them as `#ab.top`.

7. Labels and refs

There are two ways of labelling an example (or a subexample). The first is passing the `label` argument to `example` (or `subexample`). The second is placing an `ex-label` anywhere in the body of the example (or a subexample), preferably at the beginning or at the end. Typst's built-in `label` does not work for now.

If a subexample doesn't have a label but its parent does, an automatic codly-style label of the form `<top-label:subex-letter>` is added automatically.

```
The curious minimal pair in terms of scope in @pair is taken from Arregi et al. (2021).
Only @pred has a narrow scope reading of the indefinite.
#example[
  #ex-label(<pair>)
  + OK Kim is not one of the judges. #ex-label(<pred>)
  + \#One of the judges is not Kim.
]
@pair:b is pragmatically odd, but becomes better if Kim is replaced with something that can
exist in multiple places at once @ok. The argument loses in convincibility, though.
#example(label: <ok>)[
  OK One of the judges is not "OK".
]
```

The curious minimal pair in terms of scope in (8) is taken from Arregi et al. (2021). Only (8a) has a narrow scope reading of the indefinite.

(8) a. OK Kim is not one of the judges.
b. # One of the judges is not Kim.

(8b) is pragmatically odd, but becomes better if Kim is replaced with something that can exist in multiple places at once (9). The argument loses in convincibility, though.

(9) OK One of the judges is not "OK".

References to examples are automatically enclosed in parentheses. Citing two examples together is possible by inserting the second reference as the supplement, in square brackets after the first one. When the second reference is to a subexample, the superexample number is collapsed.

```
Recall the discussion concerning examples @pair[@ok]. Despite the Russian data, we should
not ignore the minimal pair in @pred[@pair:b].
```

Recall the discussion concerning examples (8-9). Despite the Russian data, we should not ignore the minimal pair in (8a-b).

A dedicated function, `ex-ref`, is also provided. It accepts references and additionally allows

- sending integers for relative numbering, with `0` referring to the last example, `1` to the next, etc.
- supplementing content to appear in the parenthesis before and after example numbers.

```
Despite the Russian data, we should not ignore the minimal pair in #ex-ref(<pred>,
<pair:b>). There is much more to the story #ex-ref(left: "e.g. ", 1, right: " etc.").

#example[
  + Only "?" is one of the judges.
  + One of the judges is only "?".
]
```

Despite the Russian data, we should not ignore the minimal pair in (8a-b). There is much more to the story (e.g. 10 etc.).

(10) a. Only “?” is one of the judges.
b. One of the judges is only “?”.

`smart-refs: false` can be passed to the configuration to disable automatic reference decoration.

8. Customization

Eggs offers some layout and styling customization and several behaviour options. The complete list is given in Section 9.

There are several ways of customizing the package options. The primary one is setting the parameters of `eggs` in a global show rule.

```
#show: eggs.with(
  indent: 2.5em,
  body-indent: 2.5em,
  sub-indent: -0.3em,
  sub-body-indent: 1.7em
)

The examples in this part all imitate Higgins' (1973) original layout.
#example[
  + What John also is is enviable.
  + What John also is is also enviable.
]

#example[
  What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.
]
```

The examples in this part all imitate Higgins' (1973) original layout.

(11) a. What John also is is enviable.
b. What John also is is also enviable.

(12) What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.

To change Eggs' config temporarely, you can scope the show rule or simply pass the content to `eggs`. Passed parameters are applied on top of the old configuration, so the parameters you passed before that are not overriden are preserved.

```
#eggs(indent: 2.5em, body-indent: 2.5em, sub-indent: -0.3em, sub-body-indent: 1.7em)[
  The following examples imitate Higgins' (1973) original layout.
  #example[
    + What John also is is enviable.
    + What John also is is also enviable.
  ]
  #example[
    What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.
  ]
] // this ends the scope of eggs
Compare #ex-ref(0) with itself but in the default layout.
#counter("eggsample").update(it => it - 1)
#example[
  What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.
]
```

The following examples imitate Higgins' (1973) original layout.

(11) a. What John also is is enviable.
b. What John also is is also enviable.

(12) What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.

Compare (12) with itself but in the default layout.

(12) What I am pointing at is a kangaroo.

To override the configuration for a single example, you can pass the options to it directly. However, note that options are split among Eggs' functions: if you want to customize subexample or gloss options, you have to pass those to the functions directly (without prepending `sub-` or `gloss-`).

```
The following example imitates Higgins' (1973) original layout.
#example(indent: 2.5em, body-indent: 2.5em)[
  #subexample(indent: -0.3em, body-indent: 1.7em)[What John also is is enviable.]
]
```

The following example imitates Higgins' (1973) original layout.

(11) a. What John also is is enviable.

Finally, since Eggs is powered by Elembic, you may apply its set rules to the elements `example`, `subexample`, and `gloss`. Elembic's show rules can also be used to style example contents in an arbitrary way.

9. Complete function documentation

9.1. eggs

Update the config with provided values, as well as run some necessary preparations. Primarily intended for use in a global show rule: `#show: eggs()`

- `it [content]`: The content. -> content
- `auto-subexamples [bool]`: Whether to treat numbered lists in examples as subexamples.
  Default: true
- `auto-glosses [bool]`: Whether to treat bullet lists in examples as glosses.
  Default: true
- `auto-labels [bool]`: Whether to insert subexample labels of the form ex-label:a.
  Default: true
- `auto-judges [dictionary]`: A dictionary of characters to convert into judges (keys) and whether to superscript them (values).
  Default: ("*": false, "#": true, "?": true, "OK": true)
- `subexample-wrapper [function]`: A function to wrap the subexample list. Should accept any number of arguments and return content. E.g. to align your subexamples horizontally, pass `grid.with(columns: 5)`. Only works for automatic examples.
  Default: (..args) => {args.pos().join()}
- `indent [length]`: Distance between the left margin and the left edge of the example number.
  Default: 0em
- `body-indent [length]`: Distance between the left edge of the example marker and the left edge of the example body.
  Default: 2.5em
- `sub-indent [length]`: Distance between the left edge of the top-level example body and the left edge of the subexample number. Can be negative.
  Default: 0em

- `sub-body-indent` `[length]`: Distance between the left edge of the subexample marker and the subexample body.
  Default: 1.5em
- `spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing around example. Currently, there is no way to modify spacing between two examples specifically.
  Default: current `par.spacing`.
- `sub-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing around subexamples.
  Default: current `par.leading`.
- `breakable` `[bool]`: Whether the example figure is breakable.
  Default: false
- `sub-breakable` `[bool]`: Whether the subexample figure is breakable.
  Default: false
- `num-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example number format. A numbering pattern.
  Default: "(1)"
- `footnote-num-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example number format inside footnotes. A numbering pattern.
  Default: "(i)"
- `sub-num-pattern` `[str | function]`: Subexample number format. A numbering pattern.
  Default: "a."
- `smart-refs` `[bool]`: Whether to format `@`-references and `ref`-references to examples Adding parenthesis and parsing the supplement.
  Default: true
- `ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example reference format. A 2-level numbering pattern.
  Default: "1a"
- `second-sub-ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Format to reference the second argument of `ex-ref` if it is a subexample. A 1-level numbering pattern.
  Default: "a"
- `footnote-separate-numbering` `[bool]`: Whether examples in each footnote start from 1.
  Default: true
- `footnote-ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Footnote example reference format. A 2-level numbering pattern.
  Default: "ia"
- `label-supplement` `[str | none]`: The example figure supplement used in references. Has no effect when `smart-ref` is `true`.
  Default: none
- `sub-label-supplement` `[str | none]`: The subexample figure supplement used in references. Has no effect when `smart-ref` is `true`.
  Default: none

- `gloss-word-spacing` `[length]`: Horizontal spacing between words in glosses.
  Default: 1em
- `gloss-line-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing between lines in glosses.
  Default: current `par.leading`.
- `gloss-before-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing above glosses (i.e. after the preamble).
  Default: current `par.leading`.
- `gloss-after-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing below glosses (i.e. before the translation).
  Default: current `par.leading`.
- `gloss-styles` `[array]`: List of functions to be applied to each line of glosses. Can be of any length. `gloss-styles[0]` is applied to the first line, `gloss-styles[1]` — to the second, etc. E.g. `(emph, it => it + [.])` makes the first line italicized and adds a period to the second line.
  Default: ()

9.2. subexample `content`

Second-level linguistic subexample. Only intended for use inside an example.

- `body` `[content]`: The body of the subexample.
  Required
- `number` `[int | none]`: Overrides automatic numbering of the subexample. If not none, the counter does not increment.
  Default: none
- `auto-glosses` `[bool]`: Whether to treat bullet lists as glosses.
  Default: true
- `auto-judges` `[dictionary]`: A dictionary of characters to convert into judges (keys) and whether to superscript them (values).
  Default: ("*": false, "#": true, "?": true, "OK": true)
- `indent` `[length]`: Distance between the left edge of the top-level example and the left edge of the subexample number.
  Default: 0em
- `body-indent` `[length]`: Distance between the left edge of the subexample marker and the left edge of the subexample body.
  Default: 1.5em
- `spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing around the subexample.
  Default: current `par.leading`.
- `breakable` `[bool]`: Whether the subexample figure is breakable.
  Default: false
- `num-pattern` `[str | function]`: Subexample number format. A numbering pattern.
  Default: "a."

- `ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example reference format. A 2-level numbering pattern.
  Default: “1a”
- `second-sub-ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Format to reference the second argument of `ex-ref` if it is a subexample. A 1-level numbering pattern.
  Default: “a”
- `label-supplement` `[str | none]`: The subexample figure supplement used in references. Has no effect when `smart-ref` is `true`.
  Default: none

9.3. example `content`

Top-level linguistic example.

- `body` `[content]`: The body of the example.
  Required
- `number` `[int | none]`: Overrides automatic numbering of the example. If not none, the counter does not increment.
  Default: none
- `auto-subexamples` `[bool]`: Whether to treat numbered lists in examples as subexamples.
  Default: true
- `auto-glosses` `[bool]`: Whether to treat bullet lists in examples as glosses.
  Default: true
- `auto-labels` `[bool]`: Whether to insert subexample labels of the form ex-label:a.
  Default: true
- `auto-judges` `[dictionary]`: A dictionary of characters to convert into judges (keys) and whether to superscript them (values).
  Default: (“*”: false, “#”: true, “?”: true, “OK”: true)
- `indent` `[length]`: Distance between the left margin and the left edge of the example number.
  Default: 0em
- `body-indent` `[length]`: Distance between the left edge of the example marker and the left edge of the example body.
  Default: 2.5em
- `spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing around the example. Currently, there is no way to modify spacing between two examples specifically.
  Default: current `par.spacing`.
- `breakable` `[bool]`: Whether the example figure is breakable.
  Default: false
- `num-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example number format. A numbering pattern.
  Default: “(1)”

- `ref-pattern` `[str | function]`: Example reference format. A 2-level numbering pattern.
  Default: "1a"

- `label-supplement` `[str | none]`: The example figure supplement used in references. Has no effect when `smart-ref` is `true`.
  Default: none

- `smart-refs` `[bool]`: Whether to format `@`-references and `ref`-references to examples Adding parenthesis and parsing the supplement.
  Default: true

9.4. gloss `content`

Interlinear gloss grid.

- `body` `[content]`: Any number of rows of equal length. Rows can be either contents where elements are separated by more than one space or lists.
  Required

- `word-spacing` `[length]`: Horizontal spacing between words in glosses.
  Default: 1em

- `line-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing between lines in glosses.
  Default: current `par.leading`.

- `before-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing above glosses (i.e. after the preamble).
  Default: current `par.leading`.

- `after-spacing` `[length]`: Vertical spacing below glosses (i.e. before the translation).
  Default: current `par.leading`.

- `styles` `[array]`: List of functions to be applied to each line of glosses. Can be of any length. `gloss-styles[0]` is applied to the first line, `gloss-styles[1]` — to the second, etc. E.g. `(emph, it => it + [.])` makes the first line italicized and adds a period to the second line.
  Default: ()

9.5. judge

Typesets the content, then adds negative space of the length of this content. Used to add a judge to the left of a text.

- `j` `[content]`: The content to typeset
  Required

9.6. ex-label

Used inside an example to give it a label. Effectively an alias of metadata.

- `l` `[label]`: The label.
  Required

9.7. ex-ref

Typesets an example reference in parentheses.

- `..args [label | int]`: One to two arguments. Can be labels or integers (or elements, but you probably won't need it). Integers are used for relative reference: 0 means the last example, 1 means the next, etc.
  Required

- `left [content]`: Text on the left, e.g. "e.g. "
  Default: none

- `right [content]`: Text on the right, e.g. " etc."
  Default: none

9.8. abbreviation

Prints the symbol in smallcaps and adds it to the list of used abbreviations.

- `symbol [str]`: The abbreviation
  Required

- `description [str]`: The abbreviation description for the list of used abbreviations.
  Required

9.9. print-abbreviations

Prints the list of abbreviations used in the document as a term list.